

I read the guide. The hackathon is about rapidly building a functional MVP with Cursor, focused on enterprise apps and complex academic systems. The guide says 24 hours, but if your competition slot is 8 hours, you should build a smaller but polished demo: one clear workflow, fake/demo data, clean UI, and one working AI feature.

The big scoring opportunity is the AI bonus: up to +3 points. It must be real, not just an idea. Example: PDF metadata extraction, summary generation, semantic search, anomaly detection, prediction, or fake data generation.

8-Hour Winning Plan

Time What to do

0:00-0:30	Choose theme, define one user workflow, design simple data model
0:30-2:00	Build frontend layout + fake data
2:00-4:30	Build core feature: CRUD, upload, dashboard, Kanban, chat, etc.
4:30-6:00	Add AI bonus feature
6:00-7:00	Polish UI, fix bugs, add demo data
7:00-8:00	Prepare pitch: problem, solution, demo, AI value, future work

Theme Strategies

Theme What You Are Supposed To Build Best 8h Strategy

1. Notion for Doctoral Research |Markdown workspace for PhD/research notes, chapters, bibliography, progress tracking |Build a Notion-like editor with project pages, Markdown preview, chapter list, bibliography list. AI: generate abstract or table of contents from notes.
2. OpenScience Hub |Repository for theses, articles, papers, with search and categories |Build upload/list/search interface for academic documents. Use fake PDFs or metadata. AI: extract title, author, keywords, summary from uploaded PDF/text.
3. Peer Review |Collaborative review space for scientific article validation |Build article viewer with comments, votes, validation status. AI: detect weak methodology or plagiarism risk using text analysis/simulated scoring.
4. ScholarTrack Budget management for research projects Build dashboard with budget lines, expenses, publication milestones. AI: alert overuse/underuse of budget based on spending trend.
5. Corporate Wiki Internal company knowledge base using Markdown Build folder/tree wiki, Markdown editor, permissions mock. AI: RAG-style question box that answers from wiki pages. Very strong 8h theme.
6. TaskFlow Fast task/sprint manager optimized for keyboard use Build Kanban board, task creation, sprint velocity, due dates. AI: estimate delivery date from previous sprint velocity.
7. MeetingSync Real-time meeting notes, agenda, decisions, tasks Build meeting page with agenda, notes, action items, assignees. AI: summarize meeting notes and extract tasks. One of the easiest for 8h.
8. SpecCraft Guided generator for technical specifications Build form wizard: business need, users, modules, constraints, architecture. AI: generate structured technical spec and detect inconsistencies.
9. DataPipe Visual ETL pipeline builder for banking data Build node-based interface: input CSV, transform, output. AI: generate SQL/cleaning script from text prompt. Good visually, but harder.
10. Supply Chain Radar Multi-warehouse inventory and logistics dashboard Build dashboard with warehouses, stock levels, alerts, shipments. AI: predict stockouts from trends. Strong if you already have dashboard skills.

11. FinAudit Accounting anomaly detector Build file import/table of transactions, filters, anomaly flags. AI/ML: detect unusual transactions using simple clustering or rule-based scoring.
12. RegTech AfCFTA Customs Assistant Customs tax simulator for import/export in Africa Build form: product, origin, destination, quantity, value. Calculate tax estimate. AI: classify product description into customs category/code.
13. CommHQ Secure technical chat for teams Build channel-based chat with Markdown and code block rendering. AI: summarize channel discussion into 3 key decisions. Easy and demo-friendly.
14. InfraWatch Cloud monitoring dashboard for IT managers Build service health dashboard: uptime, logs, costs, incidents. AI: explain raw logs and recommend actions. Very good for a technical pitch.
15. API-Forge Visual mock API generator Build endpoint creator: method, path, response schema

Default permissions

5.5

Work locally